



Kevin: Lera, there's something I need to tell you...
Lera: What is it Kevin?
Kevin: Well, I don't know how to put it in words, I saw our boss Mark sitting in a car with HR manager Bill in a parking lot...
Lera: And so? They were just in the car.
Kevin: They weren't just in the car Lera. Take a look at this picture.
(Kevin shows a picture of them hugging)
Lera: Oh my God! What were they doing in there!?



Lera: Hey Sarah, you won't believe what Kevin told me.
Sarah: What is it?
Lera: He said he saw Mark and Bill in a car and that they were hugging.
Sarah: Seriously? Mark and Bill?
Lera: Yes. He even has a picture of it.
Sarah: That's wild.



Sarah: Hey guys, did you hear about Mark and Bill?
Dave: No, what happened?
Sarah: Well, Lera said Kevin saw them in a car and that they were hugging... but I think they were actually kissing.
Dave: Are you serious?
Sarah: Yes. It's crazy right?



Dave: Hey Maria, did you hear the latest about Mark and Bill?
Maria: No, what?
Dave: Apparently, they were seen kissing in a car.
Maria: I knew it! They've been in a relationship for years!
Dave: Really? You knew?
Maria: Yes. It was obvious!



Maria: Kevin, you won't believe this, I think Mark and Bill had a holiday together.
Kevin: A holiday? When?
Maria: A month ago, they were both absent from the office at the same time!
Kevin: And how do you know it was a holiday together?
Maria: I saw a reel on Instagram!
Kevin: Reels? Of them together? Can you show?
Maria: Oh... well, it's gone now! But I'm sure they were there together!



Kevin: ...and that's why we think you and Bill are in a relationship...
Mark: Wait, what? A relationship?
Kevin: Yes. We've heard all about it! We have a photo of you hugging in the car!
Mark: Kevin, Bill's car got broken. I offered him a ride. That picture you saw... Bill could not fasten his seat belt, so I helped him.
Kevin, Lera, Sarah, Dave, Maria: Oh...



Look at the two ladies from the video;
who is the gossip girl and who is the victim?

- What do you think is the main message of the video?
- Has gossiping ever backfired on you?
- Do you think it's okay to talk about colleagues behind their backs?
- Do you enjoy hearing gossip, or do you prefer to avoid it? Why?



STRONG MINDS
DISCUSS IDEAS,
AVERAGE MINDS
DISCUSS EVENTS,
WEAK MINDS
DISCUSS PEOPLE.

- SOCRATES -



Those who are
busy discussing
your life are
probably not
happy about theirs

*Whoever gossips to
you will gossip
about you.*

- Spanish Proverb -

Share & Enjoy

"Gossip is like
glitter—you may
enjoy spreading
it, but it sticks to
everything."
– Unknown

Today we are looking at a landmark study from the University of California, Riverside, led by Professor Megan Robbins and Alexander Karan. They followed **467 people** for several days using a portable recorder called 'The EAR,' which captured 10% of



their daily conversations. While we usually think of gossip as 'trash talk,' the researchers found that a staggering **three-quarters (75%)** of gossip is actually **neutral** - just sharing information. Only about **15%** was found to be negative.

Let's listen to the findings to see if our cultural stereotypes about 'who' gossips actually hold up under scientific scrutiny.

Read the following statements about gossip. Do you think they are **True** or **False**?

1. Younger people engage in **much less negative** gossip than older adults.
2. Less than **fifteen percent** of our daily conversations consist of gossip.
3. **Almost half** of all the gossip we engage in is essentially **neutral**.
4. People mostly spend their time gossiping about the lives of **celebrities**.
5. **Extraverts** tend to gossip **much more frequently** than **introverts** do.
6. Women gossip more than men, especially when the talk is **negative**.
7. **Poorer** people with less education gossip **more** than **wealthy** people.
8. **Everyone** gossips because it is a universal human communication trait.



Why Do We Gossip?

Read through the **reasons** and discuss which ones you agree with:

- To protect the group from untrustworthy people
- To avoid internal reflection or personal pain
- To gather social currency or status
- To feel better about themselves
- To vent frustration or release stress
- To satisfy an inbuilt human instinct
- To relieve boredom or pass the time
- To discuss other people's damage and brokenness
- To find entertainment in interesting stories
- To seek validation for their opinions
- To connect or attach to others
- To gain a sense of satisfaction



Watch the video.

Which of the reasons from the list do people mention, and what reasons do they give? Do you agree with them?

- **Rumors:** These are stories or pieces of information that people talk about, but no one knows for sure if they are true. (to spread rumors)
- **Small talk:** This is polite conversation about unimportant things, like the weather or daily plans, often used to be social. (to make small talk)
- **Secrets:** This is information that is supposed to be kept private and not told to other people. (to keep / to reveal a secret)
- **Chatter:** This describes quick, informal talking about many different, often unimportant, topics. (to engage in chatter)
- **Social news:** This is a more positive way to describe gossip; it simply means sharing information about what is happening in the lives of people you know. (to share social news)
- **Hearsay:** This is information you heard from someone else, but you didn't see or experience it yourself, so you cannot prove it is true. (to rely on hearsay)
- **The latest:** This is a very common informal way to ask for the most recent news or gossip about a situation or person. (to hear / to tell the latest)

